

Commit messages

A commit is a snapshot; the message is how humans find it later

Subject first, why next

- Why you did it, and how to check it, for example, which make target or testbench to run
- The log becomes a readable story, not a pile of filenames

Browser lab

Digital Design and Verification Platform

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INTERACTIVE TOOL

Commit message lab

Write subjects and bodies that explain **why** — not just what changed — then validate against common chip-repo style rules.

Starter example: A solid message for the ALU mul change — imperative subject, body explains *why* and how to verify.

Load starter example

Challenges 0 / 22 cleared

Quiz: why: Prefer explaining? Answer: why

Answer

Show hint

Check

Next

Idle

Quiz: why

Quiz: mood

Quiz: length

Starter passes

Reject vague

Reject Update file

Reject period

Reject past tense

Good example

Suggested subject

Reset scenario msg

Quiz: blank line

Quiz: oneline

Quiz: complete

Body has why

Docs subject

Quiz: diff

Pass once

CI pin message

Quiz: prefix

FIFO why

Ignore artifacts

Style rules

Subject

Imperative, ~50 chars, Capitalized, no trailing period. Optional `fix:/docs:` prefix.

Body

Explain **why** and how to verify. Wrap near 72 cols. Blank line after subject.

Commit message lab starter

learn_git — commit message lab

Real Git practice

```
wsl - module04-commit-message-lab/examples/add_commit_log

# Track A - real Unix
# real shell session (Track A)

# practice repo: /tmp/git-cm-njs7GR

$ git init
Initialized empty Git repository in /tmp/git-cm-njs7GR/.git/

$ echo "lab notes" > notes.md

$ git add notes.md

$ git commit -m "Add lab notes"
[master (root-commit) 6fc1ec5] Add lab notes
 1 file changed, 1 insertion(+)
 create mode 100644 notes.md

$ echo "reset polarity fixed in TB" >> notes.md

$ git add notes.md

$ git commit -m "Note TB reset polarity fix"
[master 1d37722] Note TB reset polarity fix
 1 file changed, 1 insertion(+)

$ git log --oneline
1d37722 Note TB reset polarity fix
6fc1ec5 Add lab notes
```

Real shell — commit with a clear message

Real Git practice — try these

```
# git init — create a new repository here  
git init
```

```
# echo ... > notes.md — create a file in the working tree  
echo "lab notes" > notes.md
```

```
# git add notes.md — stage the new file  
git add notes.md
```

```
# git commit -m "..." — record with an imperative subject  
git commit -m "Add lab notes"
```

```
# echo ... >> notes.md — append a second line  
echo "reset polarity fixed in TB" >> notes.md
```

```
# git add notes.md — stage the update
```

Pitfalls to watch

- Do not end the subject with a period, and do not paste a whole diff into the subject line
- Avoid past-tense “Added” when style calls for imperative “Add.” And remember

Your turn

- Complete the checklist for at least one track, preferably both
- In the browser, load the starter and rewrite a few weak messages until the checks pass
- On real Git, make two small commits with subjects you would be willing to show a teammate
- When you are ready